

Illustration: Shrikishna Patkar



Chic and vogue are not exclusive to Europe anymore. We spoke to Indian designers and corporate trendsetters on what they had to say on the changing times in India

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India has grown significantly over the years. In this modern era, there is no third world. Not long ago, there were reports of attacks on Indian students in Aussie land. Several questions were asked. Some were disturbing. It went on from Indians smelling of curry (tinyurl.com/indianarticle), to our sanitation habits, thereby questioning the world's view of Indians.

A young India foresaw the need for design, and passed the Industrial Policy Resolution in 1953. This gave birth to the National Institute of Design in 1961 that cemented the road for Indian design. The world has grown and with time, products have evolved. While product automation

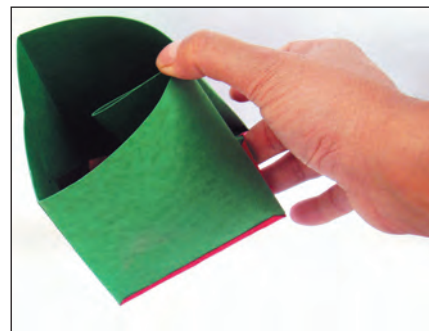
and efficiency significantly increased, product design by itself has bifurcated and become an industry by itself.

The globe recognises India

The average Indian's preference for washing to wiping is not a well guarded secret. NID alumni Paul Sandip saw the need for 'contextual innovation' to the Indian *lota* rather than loathing about Indian ways. It all started when Sandip, as a student, used to travel long distances by train from Kolkata and used to find it an ordeal to get a reserved train ticket on the world's largest rail network. Sanitation, in such situations is prime concern in India. Every citizen has a right to basic sanitation. One glance at the lavatory and you'll find a basin on one corner with a mirror too. Although, toilets are provided in trains, it is rendered useless without a tap (useless without a mug or

container, or even a bottle of water!).

Sandip adds, "I actually wanted to tell the world the Indian way is not something to look down upon. The self destructing mug ensures there is no waste lying around. It is cheap, efficient and



Paul Sandip's Disposable mug won him accolades at home and abroad

GOVERNMENT POLICY

The National Design policy recently approved by the Union cabinet envisages the following:

- Preparation of a platform for creative design development, design promotion and partnerships across many sectors, states, and regions for integrating design with traditional and technological resources.
- Presentation of Indian designs and innovations on the international arena through strategic integration and cooperation with international design organisations.
- Global positioning and branding of

Indian designs and making "Designed in India" a by-word for quality and utility in conjunction with 'Made in India' and 'Served from India'.

- Promotion of Indian design through a well defined and managed regulatory, promotional and institutional framework.
- Raising Indian design education to global standards of excellence.
- Creation of original Indian designs in products and services drawing upon India's rich craft traditions and cultural heritage.
- Making India a major hub for exports and outsourcing of designs and creative process for achieving a design-enabled

innovation economy.

- Enhancing the overall tangible and intangible quality parameters of products and services through design.
- Creation of awareness among manufacturers and service providers, particularly SMEs and cottage industries, about the competitive advantage of original designs.
- Attracting investments, including foreign direct investments, in design services and design related R&D.
- Involving industry and professional designers in the collaborative development of the design profession.